RAISING A STINK

Pitched as Jaipur's answer to the Sabarmati riverfront, the Rs 1,500 crore project launched under Vasundhara Raje funded walkways, jogging tracks and landscaping. But a pending acquisition of a small land parcel stalled the entire 47-km stretch, while crucial sewage treatment—meant to precede the facelift—was never aligned. Today, the so-called river is a tiled, toxic canal, carrying untreated waste, polluting groundwater and stinking up neighbourhoods. In 2023, the NGT fined the state Rs 100 crore for environmental damage. The executing agency—tasked with 10 years of upkeep—has now demanded Rs 423 crore more from the Jaipur Development Authority (JDA). The CM has sanctioned Rs 50 crore to push the project forward. "We hope to complete it in a year," says Vaibhav Galriya, principal secretary, urban development. But hope alone may not be enough to revive a project lost to poor planning. ■



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

3. DRAVYAVATI RIVER REJUVENATION, JAIPUR

LAUNCHED: 2016 (BJP)
COST: Rs 1,500 crore
STATUS: Incomplete, leading to groundwater pollution and stink in the neighbourhoods

NOT ON TRACK

Launched in 2011 to rival Delhi's success story, Jaipur Metro was Gehlot's big-ticket project. But 12 years after its first trial run, only 12 km of the planned 23 km are operational, with daily ridership stuck at 50,000—far below the projected 120,000. The result: mounting losses and public indifference. A revised Rs 12,260 crore Detailed Project Report (DPR) cleared in May under Sharma aims to add 43 km by 2031, but its fate hinges on central support. Analysts say the project faltered from the start. The weakest corridor was picked for early political gains ahead of the 2013 election, but missed the deadline. Raje limited funding; Gehlot deprioritised it in 2018, spending Rs 270 crore instead on underpasses that barely eased congestion. Multiple DPRs have drained more public funds, but Jaipur's metro dream remains stuck in the slow lane. ■

4. JAIPUR METRO

LAUNCHED: 2011 (Cong.)
COST: Rs 3,200 crore initially; additional Rs 12,260 crore proposed for Phase 2
STATUS: Loss-making, failing to ease traffic woes. Phase 2 aims to add 43 km by 2031



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR



5. BRTS CORRIDOR, JAIPUR

LAUNCHED: 2008 (BJP) | **COST:** Rs 170 crore
STATUS: Never put into use, it is being dismantled

ROAD TO NOWHERE

Launched in 2008 as the Raje government's big urban mobility push, Jaipur's Bus Rapid Transit System (BRTS) is now being dismantled. CM Sharma has approved Rs 30 crore to tear down the 16-km stretch—of the originally envisioned 46-km corridor—that cost Rs 170 crore to build, but was never used. Successive governments neither completed the network nor procured the required buses. Independent audits found the design failed 90 per cent of key parameters, leading to traffic chaos and accidents instead of smoother transit. "We are removing it as per government's orders and will ensure the stretch is developed well for traffic," says JDA commissioner Anandhi. It marks the formal end of a failed mass transit dream. ■